

1. Spot birds not golf

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-17T02:58:07+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/17/spot-birds-not-golf/#atom-everything>

Suggestion for hyperscalers feeling pressure over data center water use: Buy up a few exclusive country clubs, convert the golf courses into public parks, pay for guides and binoculars to get the previous members into birdwatching - help them embrace a more sustainable hobby! Google used 10.9 billion gallons in 2025 , so about 30 million gallons per day. The Coachella Valley has 120 golf courses each using ~800 acre-feet per year , which is ~750,000 gallons per day. So Google buying up 40 of those courses (1/3) should do the trick. Tags: ai-energy-usage , ai

2. Firefox in WebAssembly

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-16T23:34:16+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/16/firefox-in-webassembly/#atom-everything>

Firefox in WebAssembly This is absurdly cool: Puter compiled Firefox to WebAssembly such that the whole browser runs in another browser. Here's my blog, running in Firefox, running in WebAssembly, running in Chrome: They chose Firefox/Gecko because it has strong single-process support. The project used an estimated \$25,000 worth of Claude Opus and Fable tokens, but took advantage of a Claude Max subscription plan so cost much less in actual dollars. The demo funnels all traffic over a WebSocket protocol (using the Wisp protocol) through Puter's server - a requirement to get this kind of thing to work because code running in browsers can't open arbitrary network connections. (That proxying sounds expensive! The team had to scale the servers up to handle the traffic during the Hacker News conversation about the project.) Puter claim this supports end-to-end encryption and that looks to be true - I inspected the WebSocket messages and traffic to my own HTTPS site was encrypted whereas requests and responses to <http://www.example.com/> were in cleartext. Here's the repo for firefox-wasm .
theogbob/WebkitWasm is a similar project that compiles WebKit to WASM, but that one doesn't curre...

3. Kimi K3, and what we can still learn from the pelican benchmark

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-07-16T20:19:30+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Jul/16/kimi-k3/#atom-everything>

Chinese AI lab Moonshot AI announced Kimi K3 this morning, describing it as their "most capable model to date, with 2.8 trillion parameters". It's currently available via their website and API, but an open weight release is promised "by July 27, 2026". Moonshot are calling this the first "open 3T-class model" (I guess they're rounding 2.8 trillion up to 3 trillion), taking the crown from DeepSeek's 1.6T v4 Pro . Their self-reported benchmarks have K3 mostly beating Claude Opus 4.8 max and GPT-5.5 high, while losing out to Claude Fable 5 and GPT-5.6 Sol. A few highlights from the Artificial Analysis report on the model: "On our private long-horizon knowledge work evaluation, Kimi K3 reaches an overall Elo of 1547, +732 points from Kimi K2.6 and behind only Claude Fable 5." "Cost per task (\$0.94) is similar to GPT-5.6 Sol (\$1.04), ~1/2 the price of Opus 4.8 (\$1.80) and higher than open weights peers" "Kimi K3?s token usage on the Artificial Analysis Intelligence Index decreased significantly, using 21% fewer output tokens than K2.6." The model is also now the leading model on Arena.ai's Frontend Code arena , surpassing even Claude Fable 5. The new model is notable for the pricing: \$...

4. European Commission Adds Exemptions for Watches and Earbuds to Portable Battery Removal Rules

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-17T02:01:37Z

Link: https://environment.ec.europa.eu/news/commission-adds-exemptions-portable-battery-removal-rules-2026-07-14_en

The European Commission: The European Commission adopted a delegated act today (14 July) introducing new rules that exempt additional products from EU requirements on the removability

and replaceability of portable batteries. Under the EU's Batteries Regulation, portable batteries in products sold in the EU must generally be removable and replaceable by consumers. This helps extend products' lifetime by allowing battery replacements and supports recycling by making it easier to collect used batteries. [...] The Commission is now adding six new product categories to the existing list of exemptions. This includes wearable devices such as smartwatches and fitness trackers, electric toys, and products within the scope of the ATEX Directive (equipment used in explosive atmospheres such as explosion-proof motors, sensors, pumps or forklift trucks). See, exemptions aren't hard, especially to stupid regulations. ?

5. Quiche Browser Now Defaults to No-AI Web Search Results

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-17T00:17:35Z

Link: <https://mastodon.social/@quicheindustries/116918456229212087>

Quiche Industries (Greg de J.): Starting today, Quiche Browser disables AI overviews in search results by default, out of the box. Compare how much space and time they waste. I love the web too much to let that nonsense bury links to real websites made by humans. This is my modest contribution to the fight against the dead internet theory. Why no other browser does that is beyond me. To elaborate a bit: ? It simply opens search results in the AI-free versions of Google, DuckDuckGo, Bing, and Brave, whenever they're selected as the default search engine. ? No content blocker involved. Search results are served as-is. ? AI features can be turned back on in Settings ? Search. I wrote about Quiche Browser a few months ago, praising it for, amongst numerous other features and aspects, its built-in JavaScript toggle. This is another killer feature. Traditional no-AI web search is a splendid default. Making it an option to enable if that's what you want is the right way to do this. ?

6. Dithering: ?Apple Sues OpenAI?

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-07-16T23:28:09Z

Link: <https://dithering.passport.online/member/episode/apple-sues-open-ai>

Tuesday's episode of Dithering was a good one, especially for the DF audience, so we've moved it outside the paywall and made it free-to-listen on the web. (We don't (yet?) have an RSS feed that you can put in your podcast player for these occasional free episodes, alas.) I have a slightly different take on Apple's lawsuit against OpenAI than I've seen expressed elsewhere. If you don't subscribe to Dithering, you probably should. Two episodes per week, 15 minutes per episode. Not a minute less, not a minute more. \$7/month or \$70/year ? or, get it included with the Stratechery Plus bundle. ?

7. Speculating on how the buggy control panel extension truncated a value that it had right in front of it

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Thu, 16 Jul 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260716-00/?p=112539>

Inferring the code's history. The post Speculating on how the buggy control panel extension truncated a value that it had right in front of it appeared first on The Old New Thing.

8. Deleting Systems You Don't Understand

Source: Software and Tech stories from an Insider - iDiallo.com | Published: Thu, 16 Jul 2026 07:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://idiallo.com/blog/deleting-systems-you-dont-understand>

When I was a kid, my father bought a family home computer and placed it in the living room for all to see. When guests came to our house, they would stop by the computer and admire its marvel without even turning it on. While everyone else was careful with the computer, treating it like an important investment, I quickly started inserting discs and installing games. One thing we take for granted today is how cheap and abundant storage is. Our family computer had a single hard drive with a whopping 2 gigabytes. That's 2 GB for Windows 95, Office 95 (Word, Excel, PowerPoint), Encarta 95, all my father's work documents, and the million games I had installed. I borrowed a disc from a friend that had a few dozen games on it. I installed them all. Before I knew it, I ran out of space. The computer became extremely slow, and I couldn't

install any more games. I figured I needed to delete some games, but I was ten years old. I was not going to delete my games. I couldn't delete my father's stuff either, so I decided to explore the hard drive. I noticed that in the Program Files folders, every application came with a bunch of text files. Some of them were large, and they didn't look that i...

9. NGC 7497, etc.

Source: Maurycy's Blog | Published: Thu, 16 Jul 2026 00:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://maurycyz.com/astro/ngc7497/>

North is up (aprox). 0.53 "/pixel. [24' x 23' field] FWHM = 3.75" A relatively unremarkable spiral galaxy... but hey, what's that in the background? `var current = false; function change() { current = !current; document.getElementById("notes").src = current?"/astro/ngc7497/notes.jpg":"/astro/ngc7497/small.jpg"; } Click to toggle annotations.` (needs JS) Well, it's not actually in the background: the nebula is closer than the galaxy. This particular reflection nebulously is unusual because it's quite far from the milky way, and it doesn't have a central star. The light source here is actually the combined light of the milky way, hence "Integrated Flux Nebula". This dim illumination means it has an unusually low surface brightness: the brightest region visible in my image is 26th mag/arcsec². This is a lot dimmer than my light polluted sky which sits 19 mag/arcsec²: the scale is backwards and logarithmic: an increase of 2.5 is 1/10th as bright. --> Total exposure time: 56 * 30 seconds = 28 minutes. Used in stack: 50 * 30 seconds = 25 minutes. Telescope: C9.25 (230mm, f/10, fl=2300mm) + 0.63 Starizona reducer Camera: IMX533 (16mm diagonal, square, color) Processing: Calibration (da...

10. How Predictable Are Laws?

Source: Construction Physics | Published: Thu, 16 Jul 2026 12:03:18 GMT

Link: <https://www.construction-physics.com/p/how-predictable-are-laws>

An enormous amount of ink has been spilled (some of it by me) on the trials and tribulations of complying with the National Environmental Policy Act, better known as NEPA.

11. i've started drawing again

Source: the website of jyn | Published: 2026-07-16T00:00:00+00:00

Link: <https://jyn.dev/i-ve-started-drawing-again/>

I just miss doing art. Don't you?

12. Pluralistic: Deranged billionaires and their syndromes (16 Jul 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Thu, 16 Jul 2026 18:13:07 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/07/16/lucky-orifices/>

Today's links Deranged billionaires and their syndromes: The Mad Kings do love a syllogism. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: PoGo v binding arbitration; Trump beat some absolute losers; Public interest internet; "Close to the Machine"; Gadget-friendly chinos; Gambiologia; Monkey selfie copyright; Prison towns v prison reform. Upcoming appearances: Edinburgh, Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em. Colophon: All the rest. Deranged billionaires and their syndromes (permalink) The theory of markets goes like this: even the best of us can fall prey to selfishness and rationalization, so let's arrange society so that people acting on their most selfish impulses end up producing benefit for all of us. That'll be easier and more reliable than convincing everyone to be more generous. How do you arrange society so that selfishness produces public benefit? With markets. Faced with relentless competition, the most effective way to accumulate and retain wealth is by striving to make your wares cheaper and better....